

✂ COMPLETE INSTALLATION + ROOT MANUAL

Install Project Matrixx v12.4 Catalyst + Magisk Root

CMF Phone 1 (tetris) · Android 16 · Nothing OS 4.0 Compatible · GApps + Root Guide

Device: CMF Phone 1 (tetris)

ROM: Project Matrixx v12.4

Android 16 QPR2

Includes Root Steps

No Downgrade Required

No TWRP Required

Matrixx-v12.4-Catalyst-OFFICIAL-Tetris-Gapps-20260609-1355.zip

3.7 GB

GApps variant — Google apps pre-installed — img files extracted via payload-dumper-go

CMF Phone 1 Flash Guide · June 2026 · Flash at your own risk — always backup first



Components & Pre-requisites

Download everything before touching your phone

⚠ CRITICAL WARNINGS

- This **completely wipes ALL data** — photos, apps, contacts, messages, everything
- Bootloader unlock **voids warranty** with Nothing permanently
- ROM filename must contain "**Tetris**" — wrong device ROM = brick risk
- Never interrupt flash — keep PC awake, phone plugged in throughout
- Nothing OS 4.0 users: NO downgrade needed — already on Android 16 ✓
- Do NOT flash GApps separately — already included in 3.7 GB file

COMPONENT	WHERE TO GET	SIZE	STATUS
Project Matrixx ROM v12.4 Tetris-Gapps-20260609-1355.zip	sourceforge.net → projectmatrixx → Android-16 → Tetris → 12.4	3.7 GB	ROM
payload-dumper-go.exe Extracts .img files from payload.bin	github.com/ssut/payload-dumper-go/releases	~5 MB	Required
boot.img — Boot partition	Extracted from payload.bin using payload-dumper-go	~67 MB	Required
dtbo.img — Device tree blob	Extracted from payload.bin	~8 MB	Required
vbmata.img — Verified boot meta	Extracted from payload.bin	~8 KB	Required
vendor_boot.img — Vendor ramdisk	Extracted from payload.bin	~67 MB	Required
init_boot.img — Init ramdisk (for root)	Extracted from payload.bin	~8 MB	Required
Android SDK Platform Tools ADB + Fastboot	developer.android.com/studio/releases/platform-tools OR winget install Google.PlatformTools	~8 MB	Required
Magisk APK Root manager for Android 16	github.com/topjohnwu/Magisk → Releases → Latest	~10 MB	For Root
WinRAR / 7-Zip Extract ROM ZIP	rarlab.com or 7-zip.org	~2 MB	Required

🔍 **Important:** Matrixx ZIP uses OTA payload format — there are NO direct .img files inside. You must use `payload-dumper-go.exe payload.bin` to extract all partition images first. The ROM ZIP itself is used directly for ADB sideload.

PC Requirements (Your TUF A15)

Windows 11 ✓ · 10 GB free storage · USB 3.0 port · Platform tools installed via winget ✓ · Internet for downloads

CMF Phone 1 Requirements

Charged 60%+ · Data USB cable (not charge-only) · SIM inserted · Nothing OS 4.0 Android 16 ✓ · All data backed up

1

Enable Developer Options & Backup

On CMF Phone 1 — do NOT skip backup

STEP 1.1 Enable Developer Options

Settings → About Phone → Nothing OS Version

Tap **7 times rapidly** → "You are now a developer!" toast appears

STEP 1.2 — CRITICAL Enable OEM Unlocking + USB Debugging

Settings → System → Developer Options

- **OEM Unlocking** → Toggle ON → Confirm dialog
- **USB Debugging** → Toggle ON → Confirm dialog

OEM UNLOCKING GREYED OUT?

Insert SIM card → connect to mobile data for 5 minutes → try again. Nothing requires carrier verification.

STEP 1.3 — BACKUP NOW Complete Data Backup

- **Photos** → Google Photos → Backup → Wait for sync
- **WhatsApp** → Settings → Chats → Chat Backup → Back Up Now
- **Contacts** → Export to Google account
- **2FA Apps** → Export codes manually before wiping
- **SMS** → Install SMS Backup & Restore → backup to Drive
- **Files** → Copy Downloads folder to PC via USB

⚠ **Last chance:** Once bootloader unlocks in Phase 3 — data is gone instantly and permanently.

2

Extract Payload + Prepare Files

Get all .img files from the ROM ZIP using payload-dumper-go

STEP 2.1 Extract payload.bin from ROM ZIP

Right-click Matrixx ZIP → WinRAR → Extract Here

Find `payload.bin` inside → copy it to `C:\platform-tools\`

STEP 2.2 Run payload-dumper-go to Extract .img Files

Open CMD in `C:\platform-tools\` and run:

```
● CMD — EXTRACT PARTITION IMAGES

.\payload-dumper-go.exe payload.bin
# Creates folder: extracted_YYYYMMDD_HHMMSS
# Contains all .img files
```

Then copy all .img files to platform-tools root:

```
● CMD

copy C:\platform-tools\extracted_*.img C:\platform-tools\
```

STEP 2.3 Verify All Required Files Present

```
● CMD — VERIFY FILES

dir C:\platform-tools\*.img
# Must see these files:

boot.img           ← 67 MB
dtbo.img           ← 8 MB
vbmeta.img         ← tiny
vendor_boot.img    ← 67 MB
init_boot.img      ← 8 MB (needed for root)
```

STEP 2.4 Connect Phone & Verify ADB

Plug CMF Phone 1 via USB → accept ADB prompt on phone screen

```
● CMD

adb devices
# Expected:
# List of devices attached
# 001176478004956    device  ✓
```

Your device serial: 001176478004956 — already verified working ✓

3

Unlock the Bootloader

⚠ Point of no return — ALL DATA ERASED here

STEP 3.1 Boot Into Fastboot Mode

● CMD

```
adb reboot bootloader
# Phone reboots to fastboot screen
# CMD cursor will hang — this is normal
```

Manual method: Power OFF completely → Hold Power + Volume Up → Navigate to Fastboot with Vol Up → Confirm with Power

STEP 3.2 Open New CMD and Verify Fastboot

Important: Open a BRAND NEW CMD window after phone enters fastboot — old CMD may not detect it.

● NEW CMD WINDOW

```
cd C:\platform-tools
fastboot devices
# Must show serial number before proceeding
# If blank: try different USB cable/port
```

STEP 3.3 — DATA WIPE NOW Execute Bootloader Unlock

● CMD

```
fastboot flashing unlock
```

Phone screen shows unlock confirmation → use **Volume keys** to select "**Unlock the bootloader**" → confirm with **Power button**

- Phone wipes everything and reboots automatically
- Orange warning screen on every boot from now = completely normal
- Warning says "cannot be checked for corruption" — ignore it always

STEP 3.4 Re-enable USB Debugging After Wipe

Complete setup wizard quickly (skip Google sign-in) then:

- Settings → About Phone → Tap Build Number 7 times again
- Developer Options → Enable USB Debugging again
- Reconnect USB → accept ADB popup → run `adb devices` to confirm

STEP 4.1 Boot Into Fastboot Again

```
● CMD

adb reboot bootloader
# Open NEW CMD after phone enters fastboot

cd C:\platform-tools

fastboot devices

# Confirm serial shown before proceeding
```

STEP 4.2 — Flash in This Exact Order Flash All Partition Images

Wait for **OKAY** after each command before running next.

```
● CMD — FLASH PARTITIONS ONE BY ONE

# 1. Disable verified boot FIRST
fastboot flash --disable-verity --disable-verification vbmeta vbmeta.img
# Wait for: OKAY

# 2. Flash device tree blob
fastboot flash dtbo dtbo.img
# Wait for: OKAY

# 3. Flash boot image
fastboot flash boot boot.img
# Wait for: OKAY

# 4. Flash vendor boot
fastboot flash vendor_boot vendor_boot.img
# Wait for: OKAY
```

STEP 4.3 — DO NOT SKIP Wipe Super Partition

```
● CMD

fastboot wipe-super super_empty.img
# Clears old Nothing OS system data from super partition
# Skipping this = bootloop guaranteed
```

STEP 4.4 Reboot to Recovery

```
● CMD

fastboot reboot recovery
# Boots into Matrixx built-in recovery
# Navigate: Volume keys | Confirm: Power button
```

STEP 5.1 — MANDATORY **Factory Reset in Recovery**

In recovery menu navigate and select:

- Select **"Factory reset"**
- Select **"Format data / factory reset"**
- Type **yes** if prompted → confirm
- Wait for format to complete → return to main menu

NEVER SKIP THIS

Skipping = random crashes, bootloop, broken encryption, force closes. Even if already wiped in Phase 3, you **MUST** format data in recovery again.

STEP 5.2 **Enable ADB Sideload in Recovery**

In recovery select: **"Apply update"** → **"Apply from ADB"**

Screen shows: "Now send the package" — recovery is waiting for PC now

STEP 5.3 **Run ADB Sideload Command**

● CMD — SIDELOAD ROM

```
adb sideload Matrixx-v12.4-Catalyst-OFFICIAL-Tetris-Gapps-20260609-1355.zip
```

```
# Progress: 0% → 23% → 47% → 100%
```

```
# Stopping at 47% is NORMAL — phone verifying ZIP
```

```
# Transfer takes 10-25 mins for 3.7 GB
```

```
# Do NOT close CMD or disconnect USB
```

✓ **Sideload complete** when CMD shows "Total xfer: 1.00x" — then select "Reboot system now" in recovery.

STEP 6.1 Reboot to System

Recovery mein select karo: "**Reboot system now**"

First boot slow hoga. Android dex2oat run kar raha hoga — sab apps compile ho rahe hain. Screen black ya boot animation pe reh sakti hai 3-8 minutes. Force reboot mat karo bilkul.

STEP 6.2 Initial Setup

- Language choose karo → WiFi connect karo
- Google account mein sign in karo
- Apps Play Store se restore honge background mein
- Old backup se restore mat karo — fresh install karo

STEP 6.3 Setup Game Space for Free Fire

- **Settings → Matrixx Lab → Game Space**
- Add Game → Free Fire + CarX Street select karo
- Performance Mode enable karo
- Block Notifications during game enable karo
- Free Fire mein: Graphics → Ultra HD + Ultra frame rate set karo



Root with Magisk — Full Guide

Android 16 correct method using init_boot.img patching

⚠ **Root Side Effects to Know:** Banking apps (BHIM, some bank apps) may block on rooted device. Fix with Shamiko + Play Integrity Fix module. GPay, PhonePe work fine on GApps build. Magisk Hide available for sensitive apps.

ROOT STEP 1 Download Magisk APK

- ▶ Go to: github.com/topjohnwu/Magisk
- ▶ Click **Releases** → Latest release
- ▶ Download: **Magisk-v2x.x.apk**
- ▶ Copy APK to your phone via USB or download directly on phone
- ▶ Install it on phone (allow unknown sources if prompted)

ROOT STEP 2 Copy init_boot.img to Phone

You already have init_boot.img extracted at:

`C:\platform-tools\init_boot.img`

Connect phone via USB → copy init_boot.img to phone internal storage:

● CMD — COPY INIT_BOOT TO PHONE

```
adb push init_boot.img /sdcard/init_boot.img
# Copies init_boot.img to phone storage
# Expected: init_boot.img: 1 file pushed
```

ROOT STEP 3 Patch init_boot.img with Magisk App

- ▶ Open **Magisk app** on phone
- ▶ Tap **"Install"** button next to Magisk
- ▶ Select **"Select and Patch a File"**
- ▶ Navigate to **init_boot.img** in internal storage
- ▶ Tap it → Magisk patches it automatically
- ▶ Patched file saved to: **/sdcard/Download/magisk_patched_XXXXX.img**

Why init_boot? Android 16 moved ramdisk to init_boot.img — patching boot.img won't give root. Always use init_boot for Android 13 and above.

ROOT STEP 4 Copy Patched File Back to PC

● CMD — PULL PATCHED FILE FROM PHONE

```
adb pull /sdcard/Download/magisk_patched_XXXXX.img C:\platform-tools\
# Replace XXXXX with actual filename shown in Magisk app
# Or manually copy via File Explorer USB
```

ROOT STEP 5 — Final Flash

Flash Patched init_boot via Fastboot

● CMD — FLASH ROOT

```
adb reboot bootloader
```

```
# Open new CMD after fastboot screen appears
```

```
cd C:\platform-tools
```

```
fastboot devices
```

```
# Confirm device detected
```

```
fastboot flash init_boot magisk_patched_XXXXX.img
```

```
# Expected: OKAY
```

```
fastboot reboot
```

```
# Phone boots to system with root active
```

ROOT STEP 6

Verify Root is Working

- ▶ Open **Magisk app** → should show "**Installed: v2x.x**"
- ▶ Install "**Root Checker**" from Play Store → verify root
- ▶ Enable **Zygisk** in Magisk settings (for module support)
- ▶ Install **Shamiko module** from Magisk repo (hides root from banking apps)

Root working! You now have full Magisk root with Zygisk support on Android 16.

ROOT STEP 7 — Optional

Recommended Magisk Modules

ModulePurposeGet From **Shamiko**Hide root from banking apps, Paytm, BHIMMagisk module repo / XDA **Play Integrity Fix**Pass Play Integrity for GPay, banking appsgithub.com/chiteroman/PlayIntegrityFix **LSPosed**Xposed framework for advanced app modsMagisk module repo **Godspeed Mode**Gaming performance boost — FPS improvementXDA / Telegram



Post-Install Checklist

Verify everything before daily driving

- ☐ **Phone Calls** Make a test call — verify voice in/out
- ☐ **SIM / Mobile Data** Signal bars + browse on mobile data
- ☐ **5G / VoLTE** Settings → Network → confirm VoLTE available
- ☐ **WiFi** Connect and browse internet
- ☐ **Bluetooth** Pair earphones — test audio
- ☐ **Fingerprint** Register fingerprint in Settings → Security
- ☐ **Camera** Take photo + video
- ☐ **Free Fire** Install → launch → check FPS
- ☐ **Game Space** Settings → Matrixx Lab → Game Space → Add Free Fire
- ☐ **GPay / PhonePe** Open and verify UPI works
- ☐ **Speaker** Play music on speaker
- ☐ **Fast Charging** Plug charger → verify 33W detected
- ☐ **Magisk Root** Open Magisk → shows "Installed" ✓
- ☐ **Root Checker App** Install from Play Store → verify root access



Troubleshooting

Common issues and exact fixes

● **fastboot devices shows blank / nothing**

Open a BRAND NEW CMD window after phone enters fastboot. Old CMD sessions don't refresh. Also try different USB cable and port. Run: `winget install Google.PlatformTools` to reinstall drivers automatically.

● **Stuck in bootloop after flash**

Cause: skipped Format Data. Fix: Boot to recovery (Power + Vol Up) → Factory reset → Format data → Reflash ROM via adb sideload. Never skip Format Data step.

● **adb sideload fails / error immediately**

Make sure recovery is showing "Now send the package" before running sideload command. Run command from inside C:\platform-tools folder where the ZIP file is located.

● **adb sideload stops at 47%**

Completely normal — phone verifying ZIP signature. Wait up to 5 minutes. It continues automatically. Only worry if stuck 5+ minutes with no progress.

● **Wired earphones not working**

Known issue on some Matrixx tetris builds. Use Bluetooth audio as workaround. Check XDA thread for latest v12.4 changelog — may be fixed in newer build.

● **Root not working / Magisk shows not installed**

Make sure you patched init_boot.img — NOT boot.img. Android 16 requires init_boot patching. Re-do Root Steps 2-5 carefully.

● **Soft brick / phone won't boot at all**

Download stock Nothing OS 4.0 firmware from github.com/spike0en/nothing_archive → follow unbrick guide → re-flash via fastboot to restore Nothing OS completely.



Done! Project Matrixx v12.4 + Root Active!

Game Space → Settings → Matrixx Lab → Game Space → Add Free Fire
Magisk → Settings → Enable Zygisk → Install Shamiko + Play Integrity Fix

Updates: Follow t.me/projectmatrixx on Telegram for new Tetris builds.
Minor updates = dirty flash (no wipe) · Major updates = clean flash (full wipe)